

HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

The Spanish-American War and the Question of Empire, 1898

US.22 — Compare and contrast the arguments of imperialists and non-imperialists of the period.

US.23 — Describe the effects of American imperialism, including: • Spanish-American War • Annexation of Hawaii • Panama Canal • Philippine Insurrection • Access to Cuba • Roosevelt Corollary

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Directions. Read the three documents below. Then write a well-organized essay that constructs an argument addressing the following question: Did the Spanish-American War represent a turning point in American foreign policy, or was it the inevitable product of forces already at work in American society and politics? Your essay must: — Apply SOAPS analysis (Speaker, Occasion, Audience, Purpose, Significance) to at least two of the three documents — Use evidence from all three documents — Incorporate outside knowledge of the period — Construct a clear, defensible argument

The sources

Document 1

President William McKinley, War Message to Congress, April 11, 1898 — Bryan, William Jennings, ed., *Republic or Empire* (1899), public domain, public domain

“The present condition of affairs in Cuba is a constant menace to our peace and entails upon this Government an enormous expense. With such a conflict waged for years in an island so near our border and with which our people have such trade and business relations; when the lives and liberty of our citizens are in constant danger and their property destroyed and themselves ruined; where our trading vessels are liable to seizure and are seized at our very door by warships of a foreign nation — the expedient of enforcing American interests will justify forceful intervention.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 1

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

Document 2

Teller Amendment, April 20, 1898, Bryan, William Jennings, ed., Republic or Empire (1899), public domain — public domain

“Resolved by the Senate and House of Representatives... That the United States hereby disclaims any disposition or intention to exercise sovereignty, jurisdiction, or control over said Island except for the pacification thereof, and asserts its determination, when that is accomplished, to leave the government and control of the Island to its people.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 2

H — Historical context

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Document 3

Platt Amendment, 1901, Statutes at Large of the United States — public domain

“The government of Cuba consents that the United States may exercise the right to intervene for the preservation of Cuban independence, the maintenance of a government adequate for protecting life, property, and individual liberty, and for discharging the obligations with respect to Cuba imposed by the Treaty of Paris on the United States... Cuba will sell or lease to the United States lands necessary for coaling or naval stations at certain specified points to be agreed upon with the President of the United States.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 3

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

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Who was meant to read or
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What was it trying to make
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P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
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The question

DOCUMENT 3 Platt Amendment, 1901, Statutes at Large of the United States — public domain: "The government of Cuba consents that the United States may exercise the right to intervene for the preservation of Cuban independence, the maintenance of a government adequate for protecting life, property, and individual liberty, and for discharging the obligations with respect to Cuba imposed by the Treaty of Paris on the United States... Cuba will sell or lease to the United States lands necessary for coaling or naval stations at certain specified points to be agreed upon with the President of the United States."

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document 1		
Document 2		
Document 3		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

